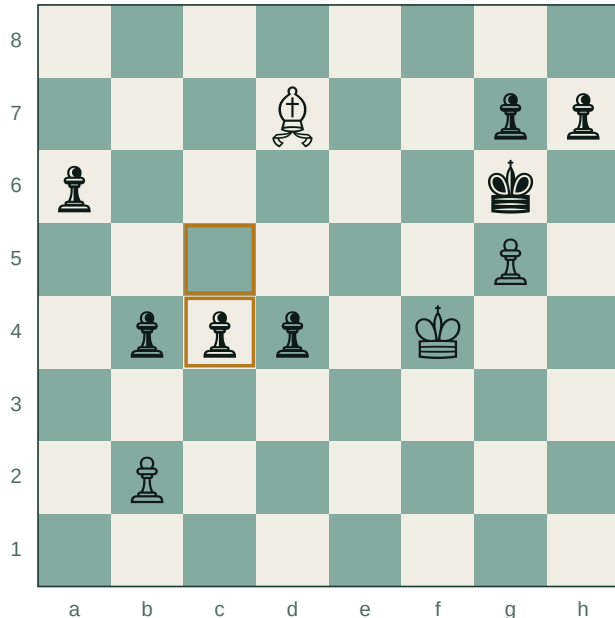


Bishop-ending decisions: White, move 39

Bishop-ending decisions

White to move



Previous move: 38...c4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

39. Be8#

39.Be8# Mate: bishop on e8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g6. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Bishop on e8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Same-colored and opposite-colored bishop endings have different tendencies, but neither label replaces calculation of the actual pawn races.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A bishop ending depends on diagonal access, pawn color, king activity, and promotion squares. Tactics can arise when a bishop must perform two defensive jobs.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the bishop's line to each target and identify pawns that can break its coverage or force it to move.

The defending king is on g6. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.